

Church Board Meeting Minutes

2026-09-14

1 Attendees

Pastor Robis da Silva, Richard Timmerman (Church Clerk), Ella de San Jose (Asst. Church Clerk), Elder Des Mills, Elder Ruth Ohman, Elder Tongai Zhou, Rachel Ohman, Leonora de San Jose, Louigie de San Jose, Charlou Medes, Hilda Medes, and Patience Mureru

2 Apologies

Elder James Mureru

3 Opening & Devotional

The meeting opened with a devotional message shared by the Pastor, reflecting on 1 Corinthians 15:58 (“Therefore, my beloved brethren, be ye steadfast, unmoveable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, forasmuch as ye know that your labour is not in vain in the Lord”).

The Pastor emphasised encouragement for leaders and members, noting that past and present labours for the church and community do not go unnoticed by God.

Opening prayers were offered by church members, committing the meeting, leadership, and upcoming church business into the hands of the Holy Spirit.

18 4 Previous Minutes

- 19 • Previous minutes were sent out by Richard via web link over a month ago with a reminder
20 sent a week prior.
- 21 • A preference was raised by a member to receive minutes via direct email rather than
22 a text/web link due to accessibility on phones. The secretary agreed to accommodate
23 email distributions where requested.
- 24 • VOTED to approve the previous minutes.

25 5 Treasury Report

- 26 • The Treasurer presented the [financial report](#), detailing the current sources and balances
27 of church funds:
 - 28 – Business Reserve Account: £91,461.16 (this balance includes the £40,955 received
29 from insurance for building repairs).
 - 30 – Current Account: £8,107.72 (used for everyday operational expenses such as utili-
31 ties and cleaning supplies).
 - 32 – Trust Fund (SEC): £37,176.70 (held by the South England Conference). -Total
33 Liquid Assets: Approximately £136,745.58.
 - 34 • Expenditure details for the year up to August 31st were reviewed, covering departmental
35 allocations including the AV team, youth retreat, Pathfinder camporee, Zoom license,
36 and music department.
 - 37 • A discussion took place regarding missing receipts for recent expenses (such as petrol
38 and fun day costs). The Treasurer and Pastor reminded the board that valid receipts or
39 Amazon invoices are legally required for auditing and conference compliance.
 - 40 • New Treasury System: The Pastor discussed the implementation of a new online con-
41 ference financial system (Church CMS/treasury software) to streamline tithes, offerings,
42 and automated email receipts. Transition arrangements and computer equipment collec-
43 tion are being coordinated with the Treasurer.
- 44 VOTED to approve the [Treasury Report](#).

45 6 Building and Maintenance

- 46 • Insurance Repairs & Schedule: The Pastor provided an update on the building repairs
47 funded by the £40,955 insurance payout for the purpose of repairs to the church¹. Ground
48 stabilization and chemical injections have been completed.

¹*Verbatim*: “The £40,955 came from insurance and needs to be used to repair the church.” - Ps Robis da Silva

- 49 • Contractor & Timeline: A new contractor (Wilson Building & Repair Services) has
50 been selected to handle interior repairs, plastering, and redecoration, starting on 28th
51 September and scheduled for completion around 22nd-23rd October.
- 52 • Building Closure & Relocation: The church building will need to be vacated for approx-
53 imately 3 to 4 weeks during the construction work. Congregants are expected to return
54 for worship on 24th October, or alternate worship locations (such as Bristol North or
55 Bristol Central) will be explored for those weeks. The contractors plan to house workers
56 on-site during the week.
- 57 • Building Prep & Heavy Clearing: A working bee/workforce is organized for Sunday, 27th
58 September (the day before work starts) for members to help clear out the kitchen, back
59 rooms, and Sabbath school cupboards. Items not needed should be evaluated for disposal
60 or recycling. Loft space is very limited and difficult to access safely, so large/heavy items
61 cannot easily be stored there.
- 62 • AV Equipment & Security: AV screens and delicate equipment should be safely unin-
63 stalled and taken down prior to construction to protect them and ensure workers have
64 clear access. General insured content covers basic content up to £10,000, and care will
65 be taken to log equipment with the contractor before starting to prevent disputes.
- 66 • Kitchen Improvement & Special Treatments: A suggestion was noted to install an ex-
67 tractor fan in the kitchen to address moisture and mold. Additionally, special anti-
68 mold/damp treatments and specialized plastering/paint methods will be utilized by the
69 contractors to resolve ongoing damp issues in the back rooms and toilets.

70 **7 Church Activities & Calendar (Q4 2024/2026 Planning)**

- 71 • Music Day: Scheduled for 21st November, featuring special musical items and short
72 reflective thought presentations from the congregation.
- 73 • Youth Days: Scheduled for the first Sabbath of November and the first Sabbath of
74 December, with youth departments organizing the services and coordinating speakers.
- 75 • Children's Program / Nativity: Scheduled for 19th December during the divine service
76 period, featuring a traditional children's presentation/play reflecting the season.
- 77 • Friday Christmas Carol Service: Planned for 18th December as an evangelistic evening
78 program to invite neighbors and share the Christmas message.

79 **8 Leadership & Appointments**

- 80 • Head Deacon Appointment:
- 81 – Acknowledgment that the previous head deacon stepped down due to heavy work-
82 loads.

- 83 – The Pastor proposed Brother Jacob (who is already an ordained deacon and active
84 in men’s ministries) to take over the role of Head Deacon.
- 85 – It was emphasized that deacons and deaconesses are responsible for the church
86 property, overseeing building care, and recommending unserviceable items for recycling/disposal.
87

88 VOTED unanimously to approve Brother Jacob as the new Head Deacon, to be announced
89 and processed according to church manual guidelines.

- 90 • Clerk Workload Sharing: Assistant Clerk duties will see shared workflows with Ella to
91 assist Richard with ACMS membership updates, typo corrections, and data management.
- 92 • Members were reminded to make announcements regarding the building closure, the 27th
93 September working bee, and relocation plans during the upcoming Sabbath service.

94 **9 Safeguarding & Compliance**

- 95 • ACMS & Membership Records: Ongoing updates to the Adventist Church Management
96 System (ACMS) are being managed to correct typos, reflect active attendance, and
97 handle member transfers or deceased records.
- 98 • Safeguarding Policies & Procedures:
 - 99 – Rachel serves as the designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) for the church, having
100 completed training in June 2025.
 - 101 – The BUC SDA Safeguarding Policy book is available digitally and in two printed,
102 laminated copies (one kept in the vestry, one at home) covering all official outings,
103 trips, and youth activities.
 - 104 – The core framework for handling concerns is the 4 Rs: Recognize abuse/signs, Re-
105 spond by listening, Report to the Pastor or DSL immediately, and Record factual
106 information accurately without investigating independently.
 - 107 – Vigilance was emphasised regarding nearby community environments, ensuring
108 proper supervision of children, keeping gates closed during services, and ensuring
109 church-sponsored youth trips/outings are cleared and communicated properly
110 through leadership.

111 **10 Adjournment**

- 112 • A brief mention was made regarding a future community/member visiting team initiative
113 proposed by Leonora for a subsequent meeting.
- 114 • The meeting was successfully closed with prayer.
- 115 • The next board meeting is scheduled to place on 12/10/2026

117 **Chair:** Pastor Robis da Silva

118 **Secretary:** Richard Timmerman